your goal than metaprogramming. If the answer is no, then go forth and metaprogram the heck out of your problem. In many cases, however, you'll find that a more straightforward OOP approach does the job just as well.

In this chapter, I showed you that metaprogramming can be overused and sometimes replaced with simpler techniques. To be fair, however, metaprogramming is still one of the tastier ingredients in the Rails pie. In the next chapter, I'll show you how one of Rails' defining features owes its very existence to a clever mix of metaprogramming tricks.